then didn't like so well, was a great firm and one for which he was personally ready to put his neck on the line in thinking forward a very long time. It's tough to read this section of that book and not appreciate that Motorola was a true quality company. But look what happened after-ward. In the next twenty-five years, the stock appreciated thirty-fold, that is, before dividends—and all in a safe, well-managed firm, incurring no brokerage costs year to year, no mutual fund operating expense ratios, and not much effort for a true believer. How often does some-one give you a successful multi-decade-long look-ahead? Darned near never. Would anyone actually hold one stock for all those twenty-five years? Well, I'm here to tell you for a certainty that one Philip A. Fisher did, as his largest personal holding, all the while it was trouncing the Standard & Poor's 500. And that is and was what Phil Fisher was all about. Finding a very few great companies that he could really know and holding them for a long, long, long time while those very stocks appreciated phenomenally. *Conservative Investors Sleep Well* is simply the best treatise I know on how to buy and hold growth stocks without tak-ing much risk. You could get that, certainly, from either book, his first or his third. The two in many ways are intellectually linked at the bod-ies, separated by sixteen years. Still, if you only read one, read *Common Stocks*. It offers more, is more radical for its time, is better written, is more timeless, covers more turf, and is more intellectual. If you can read both, do it.

In the book's second preface, I tell you a little about my father that isn't well known. But over the years, people often asked me about my relationship with my father, father and son having been in the same industry and all that. And because he was weird, and I'm weird, and often they are weird, I sometimes give weird answers. For example, when they asked, as they often did, what experience from my memo-ries with my father is my favorite, I regularly answered, “The next one.” That is no more, but it was for a long time. They often tried to pin me down with something like,“Well, weren't there favorite moments when you were younger?” I readily admit there were. He was the world's greatest bedtime storyteller, and his stories had absolutely nothing at all to do with the stock market. Many were his own fictional creations. As a small child, I loved every moment of those stories—and folks like the growing legions of Buffett-philes hate that answer. They want some notion about researching some stock. But there was never really a lot of emotion about that. It was just work. So, then, in